Portland Public School District 1st Reading

DATE OF FIRST READING: October 28, 2025

PUBLIC COMMENT FOR
Revision of
Policy 6.50.010-P: Field Trips, Foreign Travel, and Other Off-Campus Activities

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The Portland Public School District is providing Notice of Proposed Revised Policy and Public Comment to offer interested parties reasonable opportunity to submit data or comments on the proposed policies noted below.

Public comment may be submitted in writing directly to the district or through the district website noted below. Written comments must be submitted by 5:00pm on the Last Date for Comment listed below.

Open for Comment until at least:
November 18, 2025

Summary: **Revision of Field Trips, Foreign Travel, and Other Off-Campus Activities Policy 6.50.010-P**

1st Reading by: **Director Michelle DePass**
Portland Public School Board, Policy Committee Chair

Referred for a 1st Reading by: Portland Public Schools Board of Education, Policy Committee

Draft Policy Web Site: http://www.pps.net/draftpolicies

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Draft Policy Comment Form: https://forms.gle/VqYbmVA36qqADj6n6

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STAFF REPORT

Date: October 23, 2025

To: Board of Education

From: Kristen Weiler, Risk Management

CC: Liz Large, Contracted Senior Legal Advisor

Subject: Field Trip Policy

Policy Summary

The Policy Committee has moved the attached proposed amended Field Trip Policy for consideration by the full Board. Here is a summary of the substantive issues addressed in the policy, which, other than Board approval, are substantially similar to the current policy:

- Centralized field trip approval will be managed by the Senior Director of Schools and Risk Management.
- Trip leaders will foster welcoming and inclusive experiences for all students who would like to participate.
- Clear safety and behavioral expectations of adults and students.
- If a trip is not sponsored by PPS, sponsors, including staff, cannot use PPS funds, resources, or their roles as employees to support or promote the trip.
- Travel study programs are not sponsored or endorsed by PPS. These external trips must include a disclaimer, cannot use PPS names or resources, and must follow specific guidelines for sharing information and hosting meetings.

The attached chart compares the current policy to the current revision.

Significant updates include:

- Removal of Board approval on out-of-state field trips that are more than 150 miles from the Prophet Center and international trips (Risk Management's review and vetting of those and other field trips is still required).
- Reiterating an expectation of a substance-free environment on trips, noting particularly for adults which is not contained in other PPS policies.
- Updated structure and language to make it more streamlined and easier to read.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

Before coming to the Board, extensive review and approval of overnight policies by the Senior Director of Schools and Risk Management must be completed.[1] The additional layer of approval for Board review, adds time pressure on schools, especially for field trips that need to be planned months in advance (*e.g.*, international trips) or those that require quick approval (*e.g.*, out of town playoff games). Some trips have needed special, single-purpose Board meetings for approval to meet the deadline of booking affordable airline tickets or meeting other time constraints.

Board approval does not add a substantive layer of risk mitigation. It does provide visibility to what trips are being taken, the cost of trips, and whether trips are being taken equitably across the District. Staff has offered to develop other means of providing that visibility.

In 2024, the Board considered additional amendments to the Policy, which were never adopted. See attached August 6, 2024, First Reading packet.

Fiscal Impact

In some circumstances, plane fares and other prepaid expenses may vary depending on timing of final approval.

Staff Recommendation

Staff recommends adoption of the proposed amended policy.

[1] Senior Director of Schools has to approve the field trip proposals prior to planning the trip, including reviewing plans for equity, inclusion, and financial expectations.

Proposed Draft

October 2025 DRAFT Field Trip Policy

Field Trips, Foreign Travel, and Other Off-Campus Activities 6.50.010-P

Our Commitment to Off-Campus Learning

At Portland Public Schools, we believe deeply in the power of learning beyond our campuses. These experiences enrich education and create lasting memories for our students. We are committed to making these valuable opportunities accessible and inclusive for all children in our school community. When planning off-campus activities, we prioritize educational value, student safety, appropriate supervision, and inclusive practices that welcome all students.

District-Sponsored Activities

Learning activities outside the classroom can be a vital part of a well-rounded education. Off-campus experiences should be carefully designed, curriculum-supported experiences that extend beyond the regular school day or campus and support meaningful educational objectives. At the same time, students remaining on campus must continue to receive quality, curriculum-based instruction.

Approval Process

- **Single-Day Trips**: School principals can approve field trips that take place during one school day other than wilderness day trips, which require approval by Risk Management.
- **Multi-Day Trips**: For experiences lasting more than one day, both Risk Management and the Senior Director of Schools must approve the activity.
- **Overnight and International Trips**: These trips require advance, initial approval from the Senior Director of Schools before completing the detailed trip forms for approval by Risk Management.
- **Planning Resources**: For timelines, procedures, and requirements, staff should visit the Risk Management website: https://staff.pps.net/departments/district-field-trips/district-field-trips.

Creating Inclusive Experiences

When planning off-campus activities, staff should consider the following to ensure that all students can safely and meaningfully participate:

- Financial accessibility for all families
- Potential barriers or risks based on race, religion, culture, gender, sexual identity, or immigration status
- Accommodations for students with special needs, including those with IEPs or Section 504 plans

Proposed Draft

Safety and Conduct Expectations

- **Substance-Free Environment**: To ensure safety, adults participating in any District field trip may not consume alcohol or recreational drugs.
- **Behavior Guidelines**: Students, staff, and volunteers are expected to follow District policies, including the Professional Conduct Policy-5.10.064-P and the Student Responsibilities, Rights, and Discipline Handbook, while representing our schools. These expectations should be reviewed before all extended off-campus activities.
- **Safety First**: All field trips requiring Risk Management approval must have approval before departure. If a trip takes place without Risk Management approval, the Senior Director of Schools and principal will be notified.

Non-School Sponsored Activities

Sometimes it can be difficult to tell the difference between school-sponsored and non-school-sponsored activities.

If a trip is not sponsored by PPS, then:

- No PPS funds may be used
- No PPS staff may support the activity in their capacity as PPS employees
- No PPS resources (emails, logos, buses, etc.) may be used to communicate about the trip.

Anyone leading non-PPS-sponsored trips must clearly inform parents/guardians that the trip is not affiliated with PPS and that parents/guardians assume all liability with the decision to have their child(ren) participate.

Travel Study Programs

Travel study programs are a kind of non-PPS-sponsored trip organized by outside companies. We do not fund, sponsor, or endorse these external programs.

When sharing information about these programs:

- All materials must include this disclaimer: "Portland Public Schools does not fund, sponsor, or endorse this travel study program. The District is not responsible for conducting or supervising this trip. Portland Public School employees who participate in travel study programs are not acting in their capacity as District employees and do so at their own risk. Students participating in travel study programs do so at their own risk."
- Materials cannot use the name of Portland Public Schools or any PPS school
- Information cannot be distributed through PPS email without school administrator approval and proper disclaimers

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- Organizations must follow Civic Use of Buildings procedures (*see* 3.30.010-P, 3.10.011-AD, and 3.30.013-AD) for guidance on holding informational meetings after school hours.

Board Policy 6.50.010-P

Field Trips, Foreign Travel, and Other Off-Campus Activities

Original/Current Policy

The District believes in the value of experiences outside the classroom and endeavors to make these opportunities available to all. As in all other aspects of school life, PPS is committed to both the access to and the inclusivity of off-campus activities. In planning and authorizing off-campus activities, primary consideration shall be given to the educational outcomes derived, the safety and welfare of students involved, District expectations of conduct and behavior on the part of all participants, and the selection of appropriate adult supervision in accordance with Board Policy 5.10.064-P Professional Conduct between Adults and Students.

I. District-Sponsored Activities

Special activities outside the classroom are an important part of an educational experience. Students shall be allowed to participate in carefully planned learning experiences or co-curricular activities, which fall outside the normal school program, school day, and/or are off-campus when they serve a legitimate educational purpose. Off-campus activities should promote and not compromise the integrity and purpose of the District's educational programs. Plans for continuity of curriculum must be made for the off-campus activity and likewise for students remaining on campus. This policy applies to all off-campus activities, unless otherwise noted.

1) As authorized through this policy and Administrative Directives, the Superintendent's designees may authorize field trips and other extra-curricular activities involving travel off-campus when such activities contribute to educational goals.

2) District staff responsible for overseeing extended travel must notify building administrators in advance of the trip so that plans for continuity of curriculum and instruction can be assured for students remaining on campus. Those plans will be communicated to the school community and observed so that no disruption in curriculum or programming will occur for students remaining on campus.

Original/Current Policy

3) Schools and staff to submit field trip requests for review, and approval or denial, prior to any planned activities.

   a. Principals shall have the authority to approve regular off-campus field trips, subject to Risk Management approval, occurring during the course of one school day.

   b. All off-campus trips comprising more than one school day will be reviewed by Risk Management and approved by the supervising Area Assistant Superintendent.

   c. Specific timelines, procedures, and requirements of this field trip approval process will be outlined in a related Administrative Directive.

4) All out-of-state and foreign travel shall require prior Board approval with the exception of travel up to 150 miles from the PPS headquarters.

5) In planning for off-campus activities, staff members must avoid factors that might prohibit student participation, including financial burden, as well as any hazards or barriers for students arising from discriminatory policies or practices in the destination or during transit based on race, religion, culture, gender orientation, sexual identity, or immigration status. Trips should be designed to promote healthy, safe, and inclusive experiences for all students, and consider the identified special needs and required accommodations of students with an Individualized Education Plan (IEP) and/or plans under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973. .

7) Both students and adult supervisors should be acquainted with and comply with relevant District policies, administrative directives, and other guidance, including the *PPS Student Responsibilities, Rights, and Discipline Handbook*, while representing the District. These expectations should be reviewed again by all students and staff prior to any extended off-campus activity.

Original/Current Policy

II. Non-School Sponsored Off-Campus Activities Must Clearly Indicate They Are Not Affiliated with the District

The unique professional status of District staff members may at times make it difficult for students and families to distinguish between school-sponsored off-campus activities from non-school privately sponsored off-campus activities. While working as PPS staff and/or representing PPS, District staff may not develop, plan, and/or supervise off-campus activities represented as "school, class, club, etc." other than what has been approved under this policy and the implementing administrative directives. In addition, District staff or other persons may not use District email, social media, hardcopy distribution to students, or other methods of District-controlled distribution that are not open to the general public to communicate to District students or families about private, non-school sponsored off-campus activities, without the pre-approval of the school building administrator and in adherence with PPS Disclaimer Requirement (11.1.a)

1) Travel Study Programs

Travel Study Programs are activities involving student travel that are planned, marketed, and conducted by organizations other than Portland Public Schools. Portland Public Schools does not fund, sponsor, or endorse any such programs.

a) Disclaimer Requirements: Any information about travel study programs must include the following disclaimer: “Portland Public Schools does not fund, sponsor, or endorse this travel study program. The District is not responsible for conducting or supervising this trip. Portland Public School employees who participate in travel study programs are not acting in their capacity as District employees and do so at their own risk. Students participating in travel study programs do so at their own risk.”

b) Any information distributed about travel study programs cannot contain the name of the District or any Portland Public school.

c) Distribution of information by travel study organizations must follow distribution guidelines in Board Policy 3.30.035-P Distribution of Materials and Information to Students and Administrative Directive 3.30.038-AD. Information distributed about

Original/Current Policy

travel study programs shall not be made through PPS email, without the pre-approval of the school-building administrator and in adherence with PPS Disclaimer Requirement (see 11.1.a).

d) Travel study organizations must use the Civic Use of Buildings (CUB) procedures for informational/planning meetings after the school day. See Policy 3.30.010-P Community Use of School Buildings and Facilities and 3.30.011-AD Community Use of School Buildings and Facilities: Short-Term Use.

Legal References: ORS 332.107; ORS 336.183; ORS 339.155

Amended 9/2002, Amended 3/2019